UK order desks: where I would start, and why

Jack Niu, for Lleverage's UK GTM lead and CCO. Built from Companies House, UK job boards and company websites on 23 and 24 October 2026. Every fact in the table on page 7 links to its source; the counts here come from the same data.

The pick. Start with order intake into Microsoft Business Central (Microsoft's ERP for mid-sized firms; an ERP is the system that holds a company's orders, stock and invoices) at UK manufacturers and wholesalers of 50 to 800 staff that are advertising for a sales order processor right now. That is where Lleverage's proof is strongest (Topa, Dekker and Xpol run on Business Central; SIG Benelux on Dynamics 365) and where a UK buyer's pain is visible from outside: a company that is hiring someone to key orders has already decided the desk costs too much.

What I found. Of 13,806 active UK manufacturers, wholesalers and warehousing companies filing medium or full accounts (12,918 make or sell goods; 888 store or move them), 111 had a live ad on Indeed, Reed, Totaljobs or CV-Library on 23 October 2026 that turned up in a search for an order-desk, accounts-payable or purchasing role. After reading their ordering pages and filed accounts, 90 pass the filters and 32 score above 40 on four signals: a manual order desk, an ERP Lleverage connects to, more than one manual desk, and a recent change of owner or director. 29 of the 90 are advertising for someone to process orders. 11 name their ERP in public; 1 of those runs Business Central or Dynamics NAV. The top 25 are on page 7; five are worked up on pages 2 to 6 in the shape of Lleverage's own rollout guide, so an engineer starts at week 3, not week 1.

The buyer and the entry point. The sponsor is the operations director or MD (Lleverage's own description of its buyer), but the person who feels the desk is the sales office manager, and that is who the first email goes to. The ads name them: the job title above the vacancy is the desk lead.

Why the size band is 50 to 800, not 200 to 2,000. Lleverage's published customers run from 25 to about 200 staff; its own comparison page says 50 to 3,000; the CEO's stated ideal is 200 to 2,000. Companies filing medium accounts are the band where one person still keys every order and no IT team stands between the desk and the ERP. I kept companies above 800 in the list; where scores tie, the one closer to 300 staff ranks first.

The 90 days, if I were doing it from January.

Weeks	What	Measure
1-2	Call the five briefed accounts and the next 20; book discovery with the desk lead, then the sponsor	8 discovery calls booked
3-6	Collect what the rollout guide asks for before the engineer visits: three months of inbound orders, the customer and item lists, the ERP admin's name	3 accounts with documents in hand
7-10	Run the second 50 through the same sequence; add the accounts-payable desk at the first three as the second agent	2 scoped proposals
11-13	Hand the UK lead a pipeline with a source on every row and a reason on every stage	25 qualified accounts

What I am not claiming. The 90 are candidates with evidence, not qualified pipeline; an ad shows a hire, not a headcount; an ERP named in a 2022 job ad may have changed. The briefs say where each fact came from so the engineer can disagree with it in one click.

What this cost. 2,116 Firecrawl credits, USD 1.65 on Apify, and the Companies House API, which is free. No Clay credits, no purchased data.

Sonardyne International Limited, Yateley

Why this account: score 71, rank 1 of 90; a leader for its Sales Order Processing team was advertised in October 2026, and its own job ad names its ERP as SYSPRO. ad ERP ad

The company

Manufacturer. Its products "support offshore renewable wind energy projects". site SIC code (UK industry code) 26511. Companies House
Headcount: 388, average for the year to 31 December 2025. accounts, p.27
Owner: Covelya Group Limited, notified 31 March 2020. PSC register Two directors appointed 2 July 2026: Duane Mackay and Greg Reid. officers

The order desk today

How orders arrive: as customer purchase orders (POs), handled from "receipt of the customer's purchase order through to acknowledgement, shipment and invoicing". ad
Who keys them: a "Sales Administration Team Leader" for the "Sales Order Processing team" at Blackbushe, advertised in October 2026 (9 Oct, Totaljobs). The ad says the team reviews "customer purchase orders and contracts against existing quotations". Export-control vetting happens before an order is accepted. ad
Volume clues: regional offices in Aberdeen, Brazil, Houston and Singapore; order counts not found. ad How to order: not found on the site. site

Systems

ERP (the system that holds orders, stock and invoices): "SYSPRO ERP environment", in Sonardyne's own ad for an ERP Systems Lead. ERP ad

People

Sponsor: Nigel Meddings, Director of Finance (leadership page, opened 25 October 2026). leadership page LinkedIn
Desk lead: LinkedIn lists Darren Taylor as Customer Services Manager (profile needs a LinkedIn login; listed 24 Oct 2026). LinkedIn
No email address on the homepage. homepage

First conversation

1. The ad says POs are checked "against existing quotations". What share of POs differ from the quote, and who resolves them?
2. How many POs arrive a week, and how many via the regional offices?
3. Is the export-control check done in SYSPRO or outside it?

First email (to the desk lead)

Subject: POs against quotes at Blackbushe

Hi {first name},

Your Sales Administration Team Leader ad says the team checks each customer PO against its quotation.

Microtechniek, a 130-person Dutch engineering firm, has the same step. Lleverage built an agent that reads each order email, links it to the existing quote and puts the order into their on-premise ERP; it handles 45-71 POs a week. story

How many POs does your team key in a typical week?

{sender}, Lleverage

Terry Group Limited, Knutsford

Why this account: score 63, rank 5 of 90; a Purchase Ledger Clerk ad advertised in September 2026 names Business Central; acquired in 2025. ad (archived; copy on request) accounts, note 27

The company

Manufacturer: "the manufacture and sale of lifting platforms to enable access for disabled people". accounts, p.3 SIC code (UK industry code) 28220. Companies House
Headcount: 81, average for the period to 31 December 2025. accounts, note 6, p.20
Owner: Bruno Independent Living Aids Inc., 100%; acquisition completed September 2025 (note 27), PSC notified 31 October 2025. accounts, note 27 PSC register New directors include Tim Barrow and Antony Jones (8 August 2025) and Steve Hill (23 February 2026). officers

The AP and purchasing desks today

Who keys supplier invoices: a "Purchase Ledger Clerk" at head office, advertised in September 2026 (Totaljobs page metadata: published 18 September 2026). Its reference, TGJOB-02-0822, matches a site page dated 12 August 2022. ad (archived; copy on request) site ad
The work: "Matching, checking and coding purchase invoices"; "Processing job invoices from sub-contractors"; "Supplier statement reconciliation". site ad
How invoices and purchase orders (POs) arrive, and volumes: not in the ad. No purchasing role among the four vacancies the site lists. site ad

Systems

ERP (the system that holds orders, stock and invoices): "converting its suite of in-house systems to Microsoft (MS) Dynamics 365: Business Central", on a page dated 12 August 2022 describing the move as in progress. The ad also asks for "Sage Accounts". site ad Whether it finished: not found on these pages. site about contact

People

Sponsor: Antony Jones, director officers; LinkedIn lists Antony Jones as Finance Director (profile needs a LinkedIn login; listed 24 Oct 2026). LinkedIn
Also: Tim Barrow, director; LinkedIn lists him as Managing Director (login needed; listed 24 Oct 2026). LinkedIn
Desk lead: not found. The contact page shows only enquiries@terrylifts.co.uk. contact

First conversation

1. The 2022 page describes a Business Central move; the ad asks for Sage. Where are invoices posted today?
2. How many purchase invoices arrive a month, and what share are sub-contractor job invoices?
3. Has invoice approval changed since the 2025 acquisition?

First email (to the Finance Director)

Subject: Purchase invoices and Business Central

Hi {first name},

Your Purchase Ledger Clerk ad lists matching, checking and coding purchase invoices, and mentions a move to Business Central.

Lleverage reports that Royal Kaak, a Dutch maker of industrial bakery lines, uses an agent that reads supplier invoices, matches them to POs, books the clean ones and routes exceptions. story
Our order-intake customers Topa, Dekker and Xpol run on Business Central. Topa Dekker Xpol

How many supplier invoices does your team key in a typical month?

{sender}, Lleverage

First Choice Wholesale Foods Limited, Burton upon Trent

Why this account: score 61, rank 9 of 90; a night-shift telephone order processor was advertised in October 2026, and two directors were appointed on 30 September 2026. ad officers

The company

Food wholesaler, "in wholesale food and beverage distribution since 1988", selling to "professional caterers and chef's kitchens". site "Based in Burton upon Trent in Staffordshire"; the registered office is in North Shields. site Companies House
Headcount: 137, average for the year to 30 June 2026. accounts, p.22
Owner: First Choice Holdings Limited, notified 6 April 2016; no change since. PSC register New directors: Mark Earl and Ben Maxted, both 30 September 2026. officers

The order desk today

How orders arrive: "orders are placed online 24 hours a day, by telephone six days a week". site
Customers "Order by 10 pm Monday to Friday and Sunday, for next-day delivery". contact page
Who keys them: a "Customer Telephone Order Processor", advertised in October 2026 (2 Oct, Indeed), Wednesday to Friday, "19.00 -3.30am". The person will "Receive and process incoming orders via phone, email, or online platforms" and "Verify order accuracy and pricing". ad
Volume clues: "Our product range extends to some 4,000 lines"; delivery "throughout the Midlands". site

Systems

ERP (the system that holds orders, stock and invoices): not named in the ad, on the site, or in an ERP search. site Other: "First Choice Ordering App" app page. CRM and warehouse system: not found.

People

Sponsor: not confirmed.
Desk lead: not found on LinkedIn (desk titles, UK filter). The contact page shows only sales@firstchoicefs.co.uk. contact page

First conversation

1. How many orders arrive between 19:00 and the 10 pm cut-off, and by which channel?
2. Of phone, email, app and web orders, which needs the most keying?
3. The ad asks the processor to "Verify order accuracy and pricing": do caterers have their own price lists across the 4,000 lines?

First email (to the sales inbox)

Subject: Orders after 6 pm

Hello,

Your October ad for a telephone order processor runs from 19:00 to 3:30, and your site takes orders until 10 pm for next-day delivery.

Xpol, a 25-person fresh flower wholesaler, uses a Lleverage agent that reads each customer's order, applies that customer's rules and drafts the order in Business Central for one-click sign-off; it went live on 20 April 2026. story

What share of your evening orders comes by email rather than phone?

{sender}, Lleverage

Emplas Window Systems Limited, Wellingborough

Why this account: score 51, rank 21 of 90; an Order Processor who prepares specifications "from customer information and architectural drawings" was advertised in October 2026, and orders also arrive through a trade portal and a purchase order form. ad trade page

The company

Manufacturer: "We manufacture a wide range of windows and doors". site It works "with a network of independent, local window companies". contact page
Headcount: 421, average for the year to 30 April 2025. accounts
Owner: Lilliput Holdings Ltd., notified 6 April 2016; no change since October 2024. PSC register No director appointed in the last 12 months. officers

The order desk today

How orders arrive: "Order online through EVA, our easy-to-use customer portal" trade page; by phone contact page; and a purchase order form, "as submitted by the Customer through" the trade account. terms
Who keys them: an "Order Processor", advertised in October 2026 (16 Oct, Totaljobs). The person will "Estimate and process commercial quotes and orders" and "Prepare detailed specification documents from customer information and architectural drawings". ad
Volume clues: "capacity to 15,000 IGUs a week" (IGU: insulated glass unit); "23 door styles across 3 ranges, and 51 glass options". manufacturing page

Systems

ERP (the system that holds orders, stock and invoices): not found on the site or in an ERP search. site Other: "Window Designer" software ad.
Other desks: the ad includes procurement: "produce MRP and bespoke orders". ad

People

Sponsor: Kush Patel, Managing Director, and Phil Harrison, Operations Director (company news, 20 July 2022). news LinkedIn LinkedIn
Desk lead: LinkedIn lists Kloe Hiskey as Customer Service Manager (profile needs a LinkedIn login; listed 24 Oct 2026). LinkedIn
Addresses: sales@emplas.co.uk contact page; marketing@emplas.co.uk manufacturing page.

First conversation

1. What share of orders arrives through EVA, and what share by email with drawings?
2. For a commercial job, how long does it take to turn architectural drawings into a specification?
3. Does Window Designer pass the order to the ERP, or is it keyed twice?

First email (to the desk lead)

Subject: Specs from architectural drawings

Hi {first name},

Your October Order Processor ad says the role prepares specifications from customer information and architectural drawings for commercial jobs.

At SPL Treatments in Sheffield, a Lleverage agent reads a customer's PO and the standards it cites, then drafts the route card with citations in 2-2.5 minutes, against about an hour by hand, and its ERP has no API. story

How many commercial orders a week need a specification built from drawings?

{sender}, Lleverage

Stearn Electric Company Limited, Newbury

Why this account: score 51, rank 17 of 90; an internal sales role that will "process orders, and provide quotations" was advertised in September 2026, at a business with 12 trading units. ad site

The company

Electrical wholesaler: "National Super Distributor to the UK's Electrical Industry", and a "specialist distributor to many other specialist and service dependant markets". site
Headcount: 338, average for the year to 31 December 2025. accounts, p.25
Owner: Newbury Investments (UK) Ltd, notified 6 April 2016; no change since October 2024. PSC register No director appointed in the last 12 months. officers

The order desk today

How orders arrive: not found on the site pages read (homepage and customer service). site
Who keys them: "Internal Sales - Electrical Wholesale", advertised in September 2026 (25 Sep, Totaljobs), based at St Pauls Cray, Orpington. The ad asks for "experience with computerised sales/order systems" and ties the role to "branch sales targets". ad
Volume clues: "a nationally strong network of 12 businesses". site Branch and product counts: not found.

Systems

ERP (the system that holds orders, stock and invoices): not named in the ad or in an ERP search (5 results). ad Other: a CRM, not named ("uploaded into the CRM"). Warehouse system: not found.

People

Sponsor and desk lead: not found on LinkedIn (current UK employees, sponsor and desk titles; 6 profiles returned, none matching), 24 October 2026. company page Directors on file: Steven Westbrook, Leo Yu. officers No email address on the homepage. homepage

First conversation

1. At the Orpington branch, how do trade orders arrive: counter, phone, or email with a PDF or spreadsheet?
2. Do the 12 businesses key orders into one shared system, or one each?
3. The same person writes quotations and processes orders: when a quote is accepted, is the order keyed again from the customer's email?

First email (to the desk lead)

Subject: Quotes and orders at Orpington

Hi {first name},

Your September ad for internal sales at Orpington combines quotations, order processing and CRM updates in one role.

At Koninklijke Dekker, a Dutch timber, doors and mouldings supplier, the sales team keyed orders from PDF, Excel and email. A Lleverage agent now reads those orders and enters them into Business Central, flagging the lines it is unsure of. story

How many emailed orders does the Orpington desk key in a typical day?

{sender}, Lleverage

Top 25 UK order-desk accounts

#	Company	Town	Staff (accounts year)	ERP as named	Order-desk evidence	Other desks	Score
1	Sonardyne International Limited	Yateley	388 (2025)	SYSPRO ERP environment	Sales Administration Team Leader ad, October 2026	none advertised	71
2	Solina UK Holdings Limited	Elland	n/a	Sage 200	Sales Order Processor ad, October 2026	none advertised	71
3	Elemis Limited	Bristol	554 (2025)	Microsoft Dynamics 365	Customer Care Consultant - Evenings - Remote 25 hours ad, October 2026	none advertised	66
4	Castell Howell Foods Limited	Llanelli	950 (2025)	not found	Order Processor ad, October 2026	none advertised	66
5	Terry Group Limited	Cheshire	81 (2025)	Microsoft (MS) Dynamics 365: Business Central	no orders ad found on 4 boards, 23 Oct 2026	AP, purchasing	63
6	Gradus Limited	Altrincham	191 (2024)	not found	Sales Administrator x2 ad, October 2026	none advertised	61
7	Crane Limited	Ipswich	421 (2025)	not found	Customer Service Administrator ad, October 2026	none advertised	61
8	Mersen Scotland Holytown Limited	Holytown	141 (2024)	not found	Customer Service Administrator ad, October 2026	none advertised	61
9	First Choice Wholesale Foods Limited	Burton Upon Trent	137 (2026)	not found	Customer Telephone Order Processor ad, October 2026	none advertised	61
10	Pramac-Generac UK Limited	Rugby	56 (2025)	not found	Sales Order Processing Coordinator ad, expired on Indeed by 24 Oct 2026	none advertised	61
11	Newly Weds Foods Limited	West Yorkshire	649 (2025)	not found	Customer Service Administrator ad, October 2026	none advertised	61
12	Barrett Steel Limited	Dudley Hill	1,107 (2025)	not found	Internal Sales Executive – General Steel ad, October 2026	none advertised	61
13	Spirax-Sarco Limited	Cheltenham	1,157 (2025)	not found	Customer Service Administrator ad, October 2026	none advertised	61
14	Wienerberger Limited	Park Cheadle	1,318 (2024)	not found	Sales Administrator ad, October 2026	none advertised	61
15	Liquidline Limited	Ipswich	320 (2025)	not found	Customer Service Administrator ad, October 2026	none advertised	51
16	Orona Limited	Sheffield	334 (2025)	not found	Sales Support Coordinator ad, September 2026	none advertised	51
17	Stearn Electric Company Limited	Newbury	338 (2025)	not found	Internal Sales - Electrical Wholesale ad, September 2026	none advertised	51
18	Delice De France Limited	Southall	341 (2025)	Microsoft Dynamics 365	no orders ad found on 4 boards, 23 Oct 2026	AP	51
19	Liberty Wines Limited	London	247 (2025)	not found	Customer Services Orders Administrator Fixed Term ad, live 23 Oct 2026, undated	none advertised	51
20	Applied Nutrition PLC	Liverpool	207 (2025)	not found	Order Processing Specialist ad, October 2026	none advertised	51
21	Emplas Window Systems Limited	Wellingborough	421 (2025)	not found	Order Processor ad, October 2026	none advertised	51
22	Whiteline Manufacturing Limited	East Sussex	162 (2025)	not found	Order Processor ad, October 2026	none advertised	51
23	Hain Celestial UK Limited	Leeds	439 (2025)	not found	Customer Service Administrator ad, October 2026	none advertised	51
24	Oliver Valves Limited	Cheshire	149 (2025)	not found	Customer Order Expeditor ad, October 2026	none advertised	51
25	Broadland Drinks Limited	Norwich	116 (2026)	not found	Administrator - Customer Orders ad, October 2026	none advertised	51

Staff is the average number of employees in the company's latest accounts filed at Companies House; "n/a" means the accounts give no figure for the company itself. ERP is the system named on a page that names the company, or in the company's own job ad; "not found" means not found in a web search for eight ERP names or in the company's ads. "AP" is accounts payable. The score (0 to 100) adds four signals: a manual order desk (40), ERP fit (25), more than one manual desk (20) and a change of owner or director (15).

How the list was found. The counts below are this project's own pipeline counts, run on 23-24 October 2026. I started from the Companies House bulk file (Free Company Data Product, 1 October 2026 file): 13,806 active companies filing medium or full accounts whose SIC code (the industry code they register) is manufacturing, wholesale or warehousing. I collected 2,679 live job ads for order-desk, accounts-payable and purchasing roles on Indeed, Reed, Totaljobs and CV-Library on 23 October 2026 and matched 111 advertisers to those companies by name. For each, I read the company's ordering pages and searched for its ERP, and read headcount and ownership from its filed accounts (105 headcounts). 90 pass the filters (50 to 2,000 staff; not ordering by EDI alone) and 32 score 40 or more. The full scored list and every source are in the private repo, available on request.

Three UK Business Central partners, if a UK referral channel is ever wanted

Lleverage's partners page offers a referral tier ("20% commission on the first annual contract"; Lleverage handles the sale and delivery) and lists no UK partner; this page lists three.

Research, not a recommendation. Your Partner Director ad says partners drive 20% of revenue and names 'UK first'; whether and how to use UK partners is that role's call and the founders'. This page only shows what is out there, counted the same way as the rest of the pack.

Why these partners. Lleverage's order-intake proof runs on Business Central: Topa Bathroom Products, Koninklijke Dekker and Xpol. Each partner below already runs Business Central, or its predecessor Dynamics NAV, for UK manufacturers and distributors. In the referral tier the partner only makes the introduction; Lleverage sells and delivers.

How I counted. I opened each case study on the partner's own site on 24 Oct 2026. A case study counts if it names the customer, says the customer runs Business Central or NAV, and calls the customer a manufacturer, wholesaler or distributor. Staff is the average number of employees in the latest accounts filed at Companies House.

Partner	Companies House	Staff (accounts year)	Counted	Three named customers	Contact (role)
Tecman	03100541	178 (2025)	9 of 18 opened	Henry Colbeck, Plastipack, Pets Choice	Managing Director
Mercurius IT	05329986	25 (2026)	7 of 19 opened	Trendco, Tornado Wire, WESCOM Group	Founder and Director
Qi	02903407	12 (2025)	5 of 7 opened	Elecro Engineering, Adan, ATL	A director

Tecman. 9 named BC manufacturing/wholesale case studies on its site, counted 24 Oct 2026 (listing). Not UK-only: it serves "manufacturers and distributors across the UK, Ireland and Germany" (homepage).

Mercurius IT. 7 named BC manufacturing/wholesale case studies on its site, counted 24 Oct 2026; I opened 19 of the 71 listed (listing). Trendco "needed to modernise its order processing and stock management systems". It is "Headquartered in Milton Keynes" but also offers "onshore, offshore, and hybrid models" (about page).

Qi. 5 named BC manufacturing/wholesale case studies on its site, counted 24 Oct 2026 (listing). It serves "Manufacturing, Assembly and Distribution businesses across the UK" (about page). It has 12 staff, below the 20-200 range I set. It is here because the next partners inside the range, TVision and Synergy Technology, had one counted case study each (Watco, Leisuretec Distribution).

If useful, I can turn any of these into the same one-page brief as the five accounts.